Comparatives

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Compare two people, animals or things (comparar dos cosas)
- Form comparatives with -er and more
- Learn the irregular comparatives better and worse
- Use than, as... as and not as... as

Para pensar

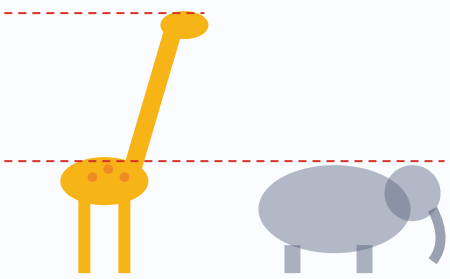
Una jirafa mide unos 5 metros y un elefante, unos 3. ¿Cómo dirías en inglés que la jirafa es más alta?

Explicación

What is a comparative?

A comparative is the form of an adjective we use to **compare two** people, animals or things. «My brother is **older than** me.» «A plane is **faster than** a train.» «Maths is **more difficult than** Art for me.»

The word than introduces the second thing: «A than B». **En castellano:** «más alto que», «más rápido que». En inglés, con los adjetivos cortos no decimos «more tall», sino que el adjetivo cambia: *taller*. Así que hay que fijarse en el número de sílabas.



The giraffe is taller than the elephant.

Short adjectives: -er

With short adjectives (one syllable) we add **-er**: tall → tall**er**, small → small**er**, fast → fast**er**, old → old**er**, long → long**er**, cold → cold**er**, short → short**er**, strong → strong**er**.

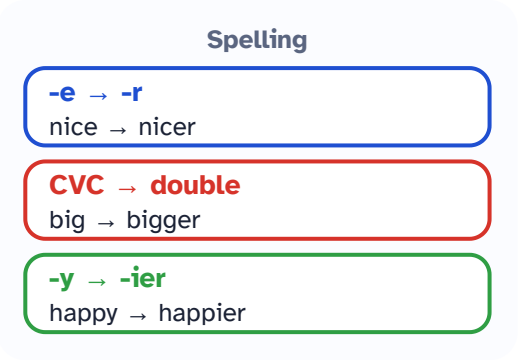
«Antarctica is **colder than** Spain.» «The Nile is **longer than** the Ebro.» «My grandfather is **older than** my grandmother.» The adjective doesn't change for plural: «These boxes are **smaller than** those boxes».

Adjective	Comparative
tall	taller
fast	faster
old	older
cold	colder

Spelling changes

Some short adjectives change a little. **1.** Ending in **-e**: add only -r: nice → nice**r**, large → large**r**, safe → safe**r**. **2.** Consonant + vowel + consonant: double the last letter: big → bi**gg**er, hot → ho**tt**er, thin → thi**nn**er, fat → fa**tt**er, sad → sa**dd**er.

3. Two-syllable adjectives ending in **-y**: change y to -ier: happy → happ**ier**, funny → funn**ier**, easy → eas**ier**, heavy → heav**ier**, busy → bus**ier**. «Today is **hotter** than yesterday.» «This joke is **funnier** than yours!»



Long adjectives: more

With long adjectives (two syllables or more, not ending in -y) we put more in front: beautiful → **more** beautiful, expensive → **more** expensive, interesting → **more** interesting, dangerous → **more** dangerous, important → **more** important, famous → **more** famous.

«A shark is **more dangerous than** a dolphin.» «This book is **more interesting than** the film.» **Ojo:** nunca juntes las dos formas: «more taller» o «more easier» están mal. O *-er*, o *more*.



Irregular: better, worse, further

A few adjectives are irregular. You must learn them: **good → better** (mejor), **bad → worse** (peor) and **far → further** or **farther** (más lejos).

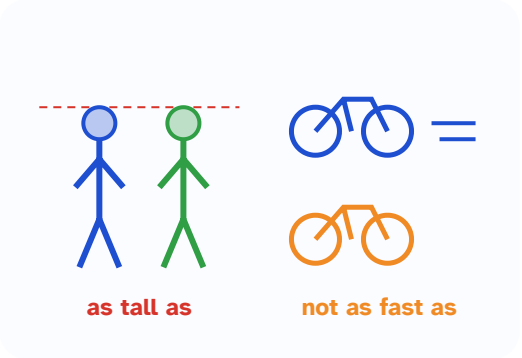
«My handwriting is **better than** last year.» «The weather today is **worse than** yesterday.» «Madrid is **further** from the sea **than** Valencia.» **Truco:** nunca digas «gooder» ni «more good». Piensa en el castellano: tampoco decimos «más bueno que» cuando queremos decir «mejor».



As... as and not as... as

When two things are the **same**, we use as + adjective + as: «Lucía is **as tall as** Marta» (Lucía y Marta miden lo mismo). «This bag is **as heavy as** that one.»

For the opposite we use not as... as: «My bike is**n't as fast as** yours» (mi bici es menos rápida). This is a polite way to compare. The adjective doesn't change here: we never say «as taller as».



Comparing with numbers

We can use comparatives with real data. Look at this information about animals: a cheetah runs at 110 km/h and a horse at 70 km/h. → «A cheetah is **faster than** a

horse.» A blue whale weighs 150,000 kg and an elephant 6,000 kg. → «A blue whale is **heavier than** an elephant.»

We can also say **how much**: «A cheetah is **much faster** than a horse» (mucho más) or «Leo is **a bit taller** than Eva» (un poco más). These little words make your comparisons more precise.

Animal	Speed	Weight
cheetah	110 km/h	50 kg
horse	70 km/h	500 kg
elephant	40 km/h	6,000 kg

Reading: city or village?

Read Irene's text: «I live in Madrid, but my grandparents live in a small village in Soria. Madrid is **bigger** and **noisier than** the village. There are **more** shops and the buses are **faster**. But the village is **quieter** and the air is **cleaner**. The winters there are **colder than** in Madrid, and the stars at night are **brighter**. The village is**n't as exciting as** the city, but for me it's **more relaxing**. In summer, I think the village is **better**!»

Find six comparatives with -er and two with more. Which one is irregular?

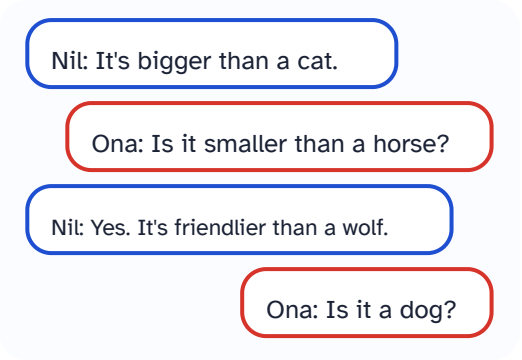


Let's practise: compare and guess

Play «Who is it?» in pairs. Think of two classmates, two animals or two famous places, and give clues: «It is **bigger than** a cat, but **smaller than** a horse. It is

more friendly than a wolf.» (Answer: a dog!)

Then write five sentences comparing your town with another town, or yourself last year and now: «Now I am **taller**. My English is **better**. My homework is **more difficult**.» **Repaso:** corto → *-er*; largo → *more*; irregulares *better, worse*; y siempre *than*.



Comparatives



Ejercicios

1. **Write the comparative: small, hot, funny, nice.**

2. **Write the comparative: famous, dangerous, good, bad.**

3. **Complete: «A car is ___ (fast) than a bike.»**

4. **Complete: «Science is ___ (interesting) than TV.»**

5. **Complete: «Today the weather is ___ (bad) than yesterday.»**

6. **Correct: «My house is more big that yours.»**

7. **Same height: Pol 1.40 m, Gal 1.40 m. Write a sentence.**

8. **Write with not as... as: «Tennis is more popular than golf.»**

9. **Translate: «El Teide es más alto que el Mulhacén.»**

10. **Compare yourself now and when you were five (three sentences).**

Practica

1. **The comparative of «tall» is...**
   - **A)** more tall
   - **B)** tallest
   - **C)** taller
2. **The comparative of «big» is...**
   - **A)** bigger
   - **B)** biger
   - **C)** more big
3. **The comparative of «happy» is...**
   - **A)** happyer
   - **B)** happier
   - **C)** more happy
4. **The comparative of «beautiful» is...**
   - **A)** beautifuller
   - **B)** more beautiful
   - **C)** most beautiful
5. **The comparative of «good» is...**
   - **A)** gooder
   - **B)** more good
   - **C)** better
6. **«A plane is faster ___ a car.»**
   - **A)** than
   - **B)** that
   - **C)** as
7. **«This test is ___ than the last one.» (bad)**
   - **A)** badder
   - **B)** more bad
   - **C)** worse
8. **«Ana is ___ Laia.» (misma edad)**
   - **A)** older as

B) as old as

C) as older as

9. **The comparative of «nice» is...**

A) nicer

B) niceer

C) more nice

10. **Which sentence is correct?**

A) My bag is heavier than yours.

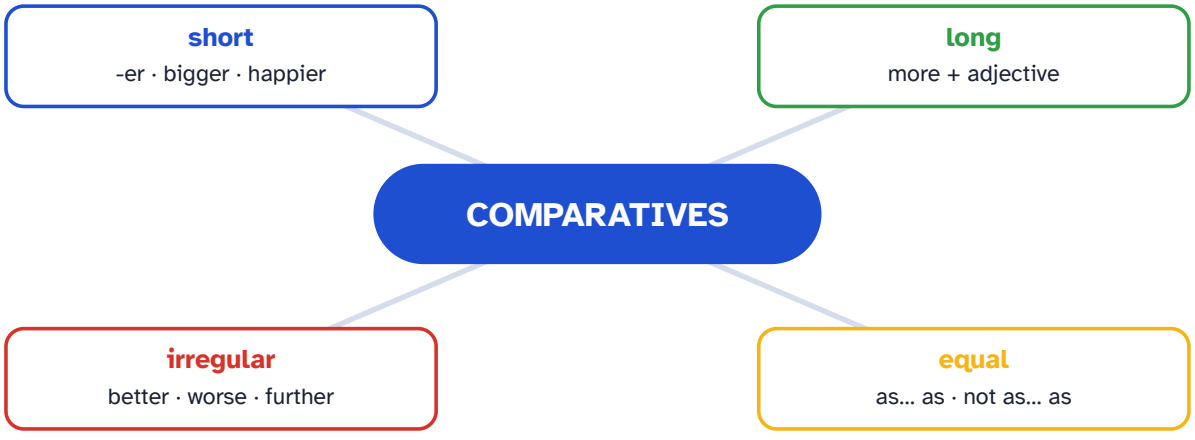
B) My bag is more heavier than yours.

C) My bag is heavyer than yours.

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve el comparativo; Cuándo se añade -er y cuándo se usa more; Qué comparativos son irregulares; Cómo se dice que dos cosas son iguales con as... as.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

Comparative

Compara dos cosas: taller than.

than

«que» en las comparaciones.

-er

Adjetivos cortos: fast → faster.

-ier

Acabados en -y: easy → easier.

more

Adjetivos largos: more expensive.

better / worse

Mejor / peor.

as… as

Igual de: as tall as.

not as… as

Menos: not as fast as.

Soluciones

1. **C)** Corto: + -er.
2. **A)** CVC: doble g.
3. **B)** -y → -ier.
4. **B)** Largo: more.
5. **C)** Irregular.
6. **A)** Than = que.
7. **C)** Irregular.
8. **B)** as + adjetivo + as.
9. **A)** Acaba en -e: + r.
10. **A)** heavy → heavier, sin more.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. smaller, hotter, funnier, nicer.
2. more famous, more dangerous, better, worse.
3. faster.
4. more interesting.
5. worse.
6. My house is bigger than yours.
7. Pol is as tall as Gal.
8. Golf isn't as popular as tennis.
9. El Teide is higher (taller) than Mulhacén.
10. Model answer: Now I am taller. I am stronger. My drawings are better.